INSIDE YOUR DISPLAY PANEL

Ever wondered what makes your display tick?

The basic idea

Commercial display technologies have seen a massive revolution in the past decade. While the early 2000s saw a rise in the use of CRT screens, right up to 2006, it has since been overtaken by other cheaper and safer technologies like plasma screens, LCD displays and many more. Current technology mainly differs on certain pressure points like contrast ratios, color gamuts, reproduction fidelity, lifespan and energy expedition. While clever marketing on behalf of giants such as Sony, Samsung and Panasonic may lead you to believe in the merits of certain technologies over others, it's best to make an informed choice about what you're really going to be investing in before taking the plunge. Curious? Read on...

Every display technology has one common backing principle. Based on the information in a video signal, the display lights up thousands of tiny dots (called pixels) with a high-energy beam of electrons. In most systems, there are three pixel colors -- red, green and blue -- which are evenly distributed on the screen. By combining these colors in different proportions, the television can produce the entire color spectrum. However, having